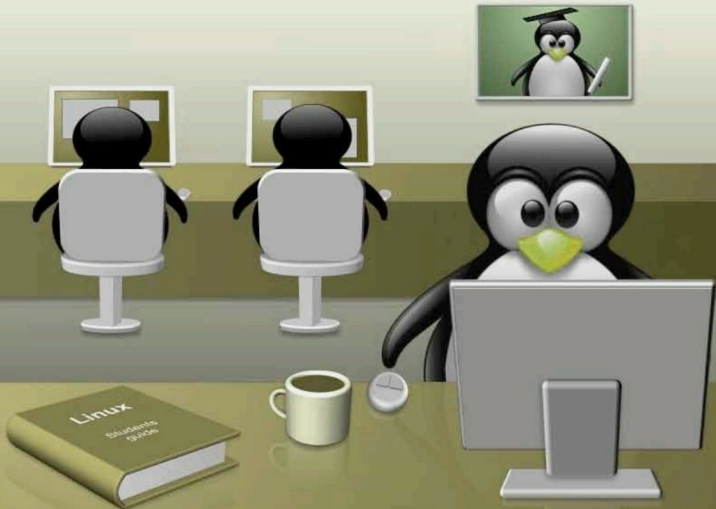




iLinuxBot

This article is to encourage newbies to use a little creativity to solve real-world problems. It shows you how to manage a Linux lab, or a lot of Linux PCs, from one machine.

I will consider you comfortable with client-server programming in C, using Berkeley UNIX standards. If you are not, please refer to LFY's earlier series on, 'How to make your own server' by Pankaj Tanwar.

The idea of my management system was inspired by botnets (you're right, the very technology used by crackers to DDoS websites). A botnet is nothing but a group of infected computers controlled by the cracker using a command-and-control channel to perform various tasks, which may be to DDoS a website or to click advertisements for the cracker's profit. For more information on botnets, please refer to the various DDoS articles published in previous issues of LFY.

Let us now design and develop a system that works like a botnet (a bot or client, and a server). Our server will be responsible for managing clients and issuing commands to clients or bots, whereas the bot will receive commands and execute them on each host. We need the following tools for development:

- GNU C compiler
- Any text editor, i.e., *gedit*
- Any Linux distribution

Code

Now, let us code a chat program based on the connection-oriented TCP protocol (*server.c* and